

Chapter 78 - Life

Feng Yue's eyes burned red, her hands clenched tightly at her sides. Due to her extreme emotional state, even her neck and cheeks were flushed with a deep red.

Her words were like a thunderclap on level ground, stunning Yan Lin and making her dizzy.

The amount of information in Feng Yue's words was too overwhelming, leaving Yan Lin momentarily unsure where to begin asking questions.

Feng Yue sat there, her arched body rising and falling with heavy breathing.

Yan Lin moved her stiff fingers, then gently touched Feng Yue's arm. "Ah Yue... I, I don't know about these things you're saying..."

"But why? Why are you so certain that you'll die on May 4th just like in your past life? Your current condition is clearly very good. Even Dr. Wendell has asserted that as long as you continue to recover properly, you'll definitely be cured!"

Yan Lin couldn't understand why Feng Yue would think this way. Given how actively Feng Yue had treated her illness after discovering it, she shouldn't have sentenced herself to death so early. Something must have happened that she didn't know about.

"Ah Yue, did something happen? Did something happen that made you so certain you'd be the same as in your past life!"

Yan Lin thought she had grasped some key point. With this assumption, everything that had happened to Feng Yue could be explained.

Plus what Feng Yue had just said about "making way for you all" - who did "you all" refer to?

Yan Lin thought she had grasped the key point, but things had become even more confusing.

Feng Yue knew her emotions were too agitated and that she had said many things she shouldn't have. She exhaled and wiped her face, standing up to leave.

"Ah Yue, tell me!" Yan Lin reached out and grabbed Feng Yue's wrist, looking up seriously into Feng Yue's eyes.

"No matter what happens, I'll face it together with you. Since heaven has given us this opportunity, I definitely won't let you die prematurely like in your past life. I'll save you, I will definitely save you!"

Yan Lin gripped Feng Yue's wrist tightly, the stubbornness and determination in her eyes like flames ignited on barren land, threatening to consume Feng Yue entirely.

"Save me? Yan Lin, who do you think you are? If I'm destined to die on May 4th, then no one can save me. Haven't you heard that saying—"

"When the King of Hell¹ wants you to die at the third watch, who dares keep you until the fifth watch."

"You can't save me, and I've long since accepted my fate."

Feng Yue looked down at Yan Lin condescendingly, then forcefully shook off Yan Lin's hand after speaking.

The indifference in Feng Yue's eyes pierced Yan Lin's heart like a cruel knife.

Yan Lin stood frozen in place, chilled to the bone, while simultaneously a feeling called pity rose in her heart.

Her Ah Yue was clearly someone who loved life so much, but now she had been forced to accept her fate. What kind of despair would it take to make her so disheveled?

Yan Lin clenched her fists and sprang up from the sofa, taking three steps in two to catch up with Feng Yue, pressing her shoulders and turning her around.

Yan Lin's deep, dark eyes stared directly into Feng Yue's eyes.

Instantly, Feng Yue felt like she was being targeted by some large predator, unable to move at all.

Yan Lin looked at her, her eyes filled with madness and obsession, an enormous oppressive force pressing down on Feng Yue's heart.

Then she heard Yan Lin speak.

She said: "Ah Yue, even if I can't save you, I'll always stay with you."

Whether you live or die, whether you're domestic or abroad, wherever you are, I'll always stay with you.

Feng Yue was pinned in place by Yan Lin's words, a chill rising from her feet straight to her head.

If she hadn't misunderstood, what Yan Lin meant was that if she died, then Yan Lin would follow her in death.

Not knowing how much time passed, Feng Yue finally came to her senses and forcefully pushed Yan Lin away.

"Are you crazy? Do you know what you're saying?!"

Yan Lin looked at her, stepping forward one step at a time. "I know."

"I can't go through seeing you lying lifeless on a hospital bed again. I can't endure hearing people tell me to grieve at your funeral over and over again. I can't bear to sleep with night lights on again!" Yan Lin's eyes were bloodshot, her head lowered as she breathed heavily, and by the end, even her words carried a hint of sobbing.

"I lost you before I even realized I loved you. I absolutely won't allow this to happen again."

"Since my life can't have you in it anymore, then I choose to end my life."

Speaking thus, Yan Lin pressed her step by step against the wall, then under Feng Yue's frightened gaze, placed a devout kiss on her forehead.

After doing this, Yan Lin finally released Feng Yue's arms, her voice hoarse as she tried to make her voice gentler.

"Go back. Auntie and the others should be waiting for you to have dinner."

In the end, Feng Yue couldn't remember how she got home.

Her mind kept replaying those words Yan Lin had said and the emotions that had surged in Yan Lin's eyes.

Until Feng Mom saw her absent-minded state and tapped her bowl. "Nuannuan², what's wrong? You're not even eating properly?"

Feng Yue came back to her senses, her gaze evasively lowering as she responded vaguely, "Mm, I'm eating."

Feng Mom felt something was off with her, but didn't ask further.

Instead, after a while, Miller brought up the new Chinese neighbor who had moved in.

"Speaking of this neighbor, Xiao Yue, you just went to help her, right? How did it go? Was it resolved?"

When Feng Yue heard Miller mention Yan Lin, even her expression became tense.

"Mm, it's fine now."

"That's good. Speaking of which, this new neighbor is really beautiful, and I always feel like she looks familiar." Miller praised sincerely.

Feng Mom looked at Feng Yue's abnormal expression and guessed that neighbor definitely had some issues.

She looked at Feng Yue and asked tentatively, "Is that neighbor someone you know?"

Feng Yue looked at her mom, wanting to casually brush it off, but thinking that Yan Lin had already bought a house near them, she nodded and said, "Mm, it's Yan Lin."

As soon as these words came out, not only was Feng Mom stunned, but Miller was also taken aback.

"Yan Lin? Is it that Yan Lin? The one you married?" Miller asked carefully, afraid she might have misunderstood due to her unfamiliarity with Chinese, since there were too many homophone words in Chinese, not to mention people with the same name.

Feng Yue nodded, confirming Miller's thoughts.

"Ah Lin... how did she come here too?" Feng Mom didn't know what the situation was between these two children. "Did she come to Vancouver for you?"

Feng Yue twirled some spaghetti with her fork, saying seemingly casually, "Who knows, perhaps."

Feng Mom and Miller exchanged glances, understanding that Feng Yue didn't want to talk much about the other person, so they had to quietly change the subject.

After lunch, Feng Yue went straight back to her room, throwing herself onto the soft bedding as soon as she entered.

The familiar scent of laundry detergent gradually calmed her heart. Here was safe.

Feng Yue gazed distantly at the ceiling, seeming to seriously look at the light above, but if you looked carefully, you'd find her eyes weren't focused on it.

What Feng Yue was thinking about wasn't the ceiling or the light, but the words Yan Lin had said.

Yan Lin said that if she died, then she would also end her own life.

Feng Yue didn't want to believe her words, but the determination and madness that had appeared in the other's eyes at that time made Feng Yue's heart waver.

What would happen if Yan Lin really died?

Yan Lin was one of the protagonists of "The Past of An and Lin³." If she died, then this book would definitely be ruined.

But was the power of the plot really so easy to resist?

Feng Yue didn't know.

Feng Yue looked at the ceiling, her mind in complete chaos, not knowing where to begin thinking.

But the next moment, Feng Yue suddenly remembered something.

She remembered that after fainting once before, she had seen that book again, except that book didn't have a single word in it.

No cover, no content.

She couldn't tell at all whether that book was the same "The Past of An and Lin" she had first seen.

She didn't know what it meant that the wordless book had suddenly appeared there.

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Until nightfall, Yan Lin still sat withered in the dim living room, the ashtray in front of her already stuffed with many cigarette butts.

The cigarette between her fingers was the last one in her pack.

The street lamps outside had already lit up, shining through the living room's floor-to-ceiling windows.

In the entire house, except for the sound of tobacco burning between Yan Lin's fingers, there wasn't any other sound to be found.

Until she exhaled the last puff of smoke, the cigarette in her hand had burned out completely, leaving only a broken ash tip.

Yan Lin had smoked many cigarettes and thought about many things.

The words she had said to Feng Yue weren't empty promises to deceive her.

She naturally wanted to live well too, but the prerequisite was that Feng Yue could live with her.

She didn't know why she had been given a second chance, nor did she know if her past life self had died.

But she was clear that being able to start over must be heaven's way of letting her prevent certain things.

And she believed this thing was preventing Feng Yue's death.

Yan Lin wasn't clear why Feng Yue was so certain she would die like in her past life. There were still many suspicious points in Feng Yue's words.

Cannon fodder⁴, you all, making way - these words were all things Yan Lin couldn't understand.

And she was also clear that as long as she figured out the true meaning these words represented, she would understand the reason for Feng Yue's certainty.

Yan Lin carefully sorted through things in her mind and also planned for the worst-case scenario.

After a while, she finally moved her stiff body and took out her phone to contact Mo Yixu back home.

"Hello, Assistant Mo, it's me."

"President Yan, is there something you need?"

"It's 10 AM in China now. Go contact my private lawyer. I want to have a video conference with him in half an hour." Yan Lin said as she stood up and walked toward the study on the second floor.

"Yes, President Yan. What specific matter is the meeting about?"

Yan Lin sat down in the study, reached out to turn on the power of the laptop in front of her, paused for a moment, then said in a deep voice: "I want to make a will."

¹ King of Hell (阎王): In Chinese mythology and Buddhism, the ruler of the underworld who determines when people die. The saying referenced here is a common Chinese idiom meaning that when it's your time to die, no one can prevent it.

² Nuannuan (囡囡): A term of endearment meaning "little girl" or "baby girl," commonly used by parents in some Chinese dialects, particularly in the Shanghai area.

³ "The Past of An and Lin" (安霖往事): This refers to the novel that Feng Yue discovered she was a character in. "An" likely refers to the character An An (安安), and "Lin" refers to Yan Lin (严霖).

⁴ Cannon fodder (炮灰): A term originating from web novels and fan fiction, referring to minor characters who exist only to die or suffer to advance the plot, typically supporting characters with no real narrative importance.